

BRENDA ONG

Chief of Staff · Program & Business Operations · AI-Native Operating Systems

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SUMMARY

Chief-of-staff-style operator with 13+ years in program operations, business operations and startup operations across government, INTERPOL, frontier technology and an early-stage company. Builds the operating layer small teams run on: planning cadences, trackers, decision logs, escalation paths, onboarding systems and board-ready briefing materials. AI-native - prototypes lightweight internal tools with Claude Code, Codex and Python, cutting report preparation 30% and manual consolidation 66.7%. Manages a S\$65M+ portfolio with external funding awards and milestone-based disbursement tracking, raised on-time milestone delivery 74% to 90%, and holds sensitive candidate, board and national-security context with discretion. MIT Sloan Fellows MBA.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Chief of Staff · Program Operations · Business Operations · Special Projects · Project Management · Startup Operations · Research Operations · Operating Cadence & Planning Rhythms · Trackers & Source-of-Truth Systems · Decision Logs & Follow-Up Systems · Board & Leadership Materials · Executive Briefings · Portfolio & Dependency Visibility · Blockers, Owners & Decision Dates · Grantmaking & Funding Operations · Diligence Coordination · Disbursement & Milestone Tracking · Finance & Legal Handoffs · Hiring Pipelines & Candidate Trackers · Onboarding & Context Systems · Advisor, Fellow & Collaborator Pipelines · Cross-Functional Coordination · AI Agents & Automation · Vibe Coding (Claude Code, Codex) · Google Workspace & Drive · Python, SQL, Tableau · AI Governance & Model Safety · Discretion with Sensitive Context

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HOME TEAM SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY AGENCY (HTX) - SINGAPORE

Jul 2025 – Present

Principal Scientist, Disruptive Technologies Office (Operating Lead, Emerging-Technology Portfolio)

Own the planning, coordination and decision layer for a multi-workstream emerging-technology programme spanning AI, model safety, space and quantum, across frontline agencies, researchers, engineers and industry partners.

- Built an AI-assisted analyst workflow with Claude Code and Codex, cutting report preparation time 30%.
- Raised on-time milestone delivery from 74% to 90% across a S\$65M+ multi-year technology portfolio.
- Made external funding awards to research partners and tracked disbursement against milestones across the S\$65M+ portfolio.
- Ran readiness-review cadence with owners, risk registers and go/no-go criteria, closing ~90% of pre-launch findings.
- Prototyped two LLM tools - sentiment forecasting and a model behaviour-drift dashboard - evidencing leadership adoption decisions.
- Led 8 executive workshops with 40+ senior leaders, converting broad strategy into 6 funded, roadmapped opportunities.
- Established an operating model of ownership maps and escalation paths, adopted across 10 frontline agencies.
- Authored 7 leadership briefings translating a technology roadmap into board-level investment and adoption decisions.
- Coordinated handoffs across 10 technical and frontline teams, tracking dependencies and corrective actions through closure.
- Deployed 3 AI systems - a research agent, summarisation pipeline and auto-updating tracker - removing recurring team work.

LYMEALERT - BOSTON, MA

Jun 2023 – Present

Co-Founder, Chief Operating Officer & Chief Marketing Officer (Strategic Advisor since Jul 2025)

Built the operating foundation of a pre-seed diagnostics company from zero while completing the MIT Sloan Fellows MBA.

- Automated reporting and task-tracking across 5 workstreams, cutting manual consolidation 66.7% (~10 hours weekly).
- Produced investor materials, diligence responses and use-of-funds scenarios supporting US\$5M+ in financing.
- Raised milestone completion from 65% to 90% using weekly readiness reviews and dependency tracking.
- Built a pre-launch operating model across 6 workflow domains, defining owners, decision protocols and escalation handling.

SINGAPORE POLICE FORCE - SINGAPORE

2013 – 2023

Assistant Director, Public Communications (Trust, Safety & 24/7 Incident Operations)

Feb 2021 – May 2023

Directed a 28-person 24/7 function covering incident triage, online-harms enforcement, disinformation response and national spokesperson duties.

- Ran a 24/7 incident triage queue at 100+ cases daily, sustaining a 99% response SLA.
- Built a QA and calibration system reviewing 500+ decisions monthly, cutting hand-off failures 40% and overdue cases 45%.
- Cut misinformation mean-time-to-detection over 50% to three hours using social-listening and rules-based alerting.
- Ran screening, interview panels, candidate trackers and offer decisions with HR to build a 10-person unit.
- Managed and developed a 28-person team, sustaining employee engagement above 75% under sustained crisis load.
- Directed counter-narrative response to 20+ disinformation campaigns, supporting a 96% public trust rating.

- Enforced content policy across 5 platforms serving 1.3M+ users, routing child-safety and vulnerable-person cases to intervention.

Head of Operations, Tanglin Police Division

Aug 2019 – Feb 2021

Owned operations, resourcing and policy for a division of ~1,500 officers.

- Reallocated 33% of a S\$10M annual resource pool to priority risks while holding 98% service performance.
- Stood up a 35-officer counterterrorism capability adopted across 7 divisions, cutting per-shift staffing 20%.
- Built the onboarding and runbook system for a new counterterrorism structure, onboarding 300+ officers.
- Ran a 10-exercise annual programme, lifting readiness scores 25% and closing 98% of after-action items on deadline.

Commanding Officer, Bukit Panjang Neighbourhood Police Centre

Jan 2018 – Aug 2019

- Built a Python and Tableau crime-analytics model redesigning patrol deployment, cutting five major offences 30%.
- Raised employee engagement from 80% to 93% across an 88-officer command.
- Founded the force's first Women's Committee, a model subsequently adopted across the Singapore Police Force.
- Co-authored the AI ethics paper seeding Singapore's Advisory Council on the Ethical Use of AI and Data.

Deputy Team Leader, Crisis Negotiation Unit (concurrent)

Jul 2017 – May 2023

- Stabilised 40+ threat-to-life incidents using structured de-escalation and decision thresholds still in use.

Operations Officer, Future Operations Division (founding 'skunkworks' unit)

Jan 2015 – Jan 2018

- Cut duplicative systems 42.9% by programme-managing a 10-year joint technology masterplan across 10 departments.
- Centralised fragmented emergency call centres into a 24/7 Ops Command, improving response times 20% across 1M+ annual calls.
- Raised pilot-to-adoption conversion from 10% to 50% by adding stage gates, success measures and post-pilot ownership.
- Devised national cybersecurity and data-security policy for Singapore's National Digital Identity programme.

Investigation Officer, Central Police Division

Jun 2013 – Jun 2014

- Solved 20+ investigations monthly at 85%+ solvability; built the case-tracking system and investigative rulebook.

INTERPOL GENERAL SECRETARIAT - LYON, FRANCE

Jun 2014 – Jan 2015

Executive, Strategic Planning Directorate

- Prioritised, budgeted and tracked the full initiative portfolio of a 195-country organisation.
- Produced the Environmental Scan foresight series briefing senior leaders on 5–10 year law-enforcement risk.
- Staffed the Secretary-General with executive mission briefs across international engagements.
- Revised enterprise risk-management policy and drafted SOPs for risk reporting and monitoring.
- Tracked 25 funded initiatives from intake to decision date, holding ~80% to schedule.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Eight open research projects on AI misuse, safety evaluation, enforcement operations and crisis communications; four most relevant shown. All at brendaong.com and github.com/bibiong.

Enforcement Operations Simulator — Discrete-event simulation of a 1,700-alert/day Trust & Safety enforcement queue (~4,100 lines of Python, 82 tests), plus the written operating model it exists to test.

- Quantified a free 1.4-point SLA gain from reshaping shift coverage at zero headcount cost, sized the residual as a 2-reviewer ask, and showed a one-line escalation guard is worth 25 points of P0 attainment at 12x burst load.

APAC Regulatory Readiness — A maintained tracker of platform regulation across ten Asia-Pacific jurisdictions, plus a regulator response workflow, a measured AI toolkit and a readiness assessment framework. 17 instruments tracked.

- Built the readiness framework and regulator response workflow on top of the tracker, turning a concurrency problem — one product change triggering obligations in eight jurisdictions on eight deadlines — into a dated, owned plan; measured five models and found none surfaced threshold carve-outs.

AI Incident After-Action Library — Twelve structured after-action reviews of public AI safety incidents — timeline, contributing factors, detection gap, corrective actions with owners — with schema validation and generated cross-library analysis.

- Tracked 66 corrective actions to named owners and action type, showing half are unobservable from outside; median detection-to-mitigation of 2 days against a 47-day worst-case detection lag.

Policy-to-Eval Harness — Builds the missing step between a written usage policy and a decision an evaluator can score. 400 borderline prompts across 5 open-weight models, 2,000 scored responses.

- Designed the measurement so both failure directions report in the same table, and published the calibration failure alongside the results rather than the headline number alone.

EDUCATION

MBA, Sloan Fellows Program - MIT Sloan School of Management

2024

ASEAN Fellow · Specialisation in Business Analytics; coursework in AI & Machine Learning · GPA 4.9/5.0

MA, Security Studies - Georgetown University, School of Foreign Service

2012

Outstanding Academic Achievement · Concentration: International Security · GPA 3.89/4.0

BA (Hons, First Class), Politics, Psychology & Sociology - University of Cambridge

2011

Kerslake Scholar, Emmanuel College; Awarded Honorary MA in 2015

MTech in AI Systems (in progress) - National University of Singapore, ISS

2026 – present

CERTIFICATIONS, SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Board & Leadership: Honorary Secretary (Board Member), POLWEL Cooperative Society (2022–present) - own agendas, board papers, minutes and follow-up actions across 4 board meetings annually · The Commendation Medal (COVID-19), Prime Minister's Office, Singapore (2023) · Singapore Government Overseas Scholarship

Certifications: AI Security, Lakera (2024) · Data Science Professional, DataCamp (2024) · AI Nanodegree, Heicoders (2023) · Certified ScrumMaster, Scrum Alliance (2023) · Google Analytics IQ (2023) · Google Data Analytics, Coursera (2022)

Tools & Technical: Claude Code · Codex · LLM prototyping & evaluation · Python · SQL · R · Tableau · Power BI · Google Workspace & Drive · Notion-style trackers · Workflow automation

Other Skills: Trained Crisis Negotiator · Media Spokesperson Training · Futures Methodologies

Languages: English (native) · Mandarin Chinese (native) · French (basic)